

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Pronunciation Spot: Hi? Hello? How can I help you?



Learning Outcome

Accurately use important information about people's jobs and places of work in communicative situations.

Can Do Statements

- I can start and end a conversation on the phone.
- I can link sounds in spoken English.
- I can leave a message.

Ask your partner:

- How important is it to leave a voicemail message?
- Have you left voicemail messages? Why?
- What information should you include? Why?





Let's Explore!

Miranda calls Farmani's office to **set up*** a meeting.

* To "set up" means to make the arrangements that are necessary for something to happen.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Receptionist:** Thank you for calling Farmani's office. Hannah speaking. How can I help you?
- Miranda:** Oh, hi! May I speak to Mr. Farmani, please?
- Receptionist:** Just a moment. Can I put you on hold?
- Miranda:** Sure!
- Receptionist:** Hello ma'am. Unfortunately, Mr. Farmani can't take your call at this moment. He is in the middle of a meeting. Would you like to leave a message?
- Miranda:** Yes, please. Do you have a pen handy?
- Receptionist:** Yes, go ahead!
- Miranda:** Could you tell him that Miranda Morehouse, Head of Fashion at Polygon, called?
- Receptionist:** Sorry, I didn't catch that.
- Miranda:** Miranda Morehouse – Head of Fashion at Polygon.
- Receptionist:** Great. I've got it all down. I'll have him call you back. Is there anything else I could help you with?
- Miranda:** No, that's all. Thank you!





Let's Practice!

Thank you for calling. How may I direct your call?

Instructions: Read the dialogue. Circle all the mistakes.

Receptionist: Thank you for calling Giorgio Farmani's office. Hannah speaking for Farmani.

How can I help you?

Miranda: Oh, hi! May I speak to is Mr. Farmani, in please?

Receptionist: One a moment. Can I put you on transfer hold?

Miranda: Sure!

Receptionist: Hello ma'am. Unfortunately, Mr. Farmani can't take your call at the moment.

Would you like to take leave a message?

Miranda: Yes, please. Could you tell him that Miranda Morehouse – Head of Fashion at Polygon called?

Receptionist: Sorry, I didn't catch repeat that.

Miranda: Miranda Morehouse – Head of Fashion at Polygon.

Receptionist: Great. I've got it all down.

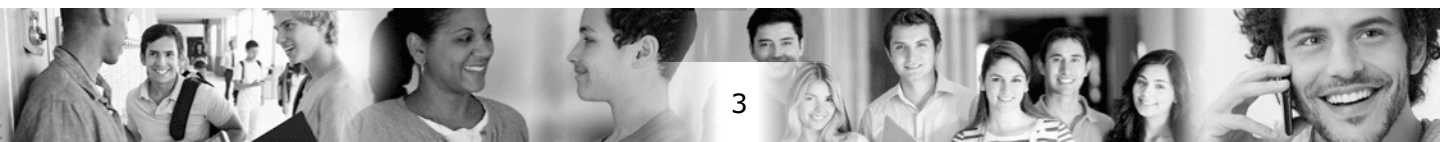


Let's Practice!

It's time to leave a message!

Instructions: Proofread the sentences. Correct the mistakes. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

I am Giorgio Farmani from Holly's. I'm call for the proposal. Might you tell Ms. Morehouse to call you as soon as she gets this? She can talk me at 212-555-9702.
You're welcome.





Extension Activity

You need to leave a message for your friend.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Pretend that you are calling your friend. They don't pick up their phone, and you can't text them. You have to leave a voicemail message for them.
- Write out your message (70-80 words). Remember to include the important information. Proofread your message.
- Practice reading your message aloud.
- Listen to a partner's message.
- Respond back to their message.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I leave a message for a friend.

☐
☐

I listen to and respond to a message.

☐
☐

I link sounds in English when I speak.

☐
☐


Target Words

- **to put on hold** (expression): to make someone wait until the person they have called is ready to answer
e.g. Can I put you on hold for a few minutes please?
- **take a call** (expression): speak to someone on the phone when someone else has answered
e.g. He can't take your call at the moment.
- **in the middle of** (expression): busy doing something; busy with
e.g. He is in the middle of a meeting.
- **handy** (adjective): near and easy to use
e.g. Do you have a pen handy?
- **to catch** (verb): to hear something
Example: Sorry, I didn't catch that.
- **I've got it all down.** (expression): used to say that you have written down a short note
e.g. **Theo**: Did you write it down?
James: Yes, I've got it all down.





Learning Points

Connected Speech: Linking Sounds In Spoken English

In spoken English, sometimes you may have problems understanding what people are saying. This is not because you don't know the words being said or the person was speaking too fast, but because the words have been connected and the sounds changed.

In English, native speakers tend to link the consonant at the end of a word with the vowel at the beginning of the following word.

Examples:

- How can I help you?
- May I speak to Mr. Durham, please?
- Can I put you on hold?
- I've got it all down.

Starting And Ending A Phone Conversation

Talking on the telephone can be challenging for a variety of reasons. Firstly, you are not able to see the person you're talking to, so there's no body language to be read. Secondly, it requires a special set of words, phrases, and expressions.

The charts below will help you to speak on the phone confidently in business and personal situations.

Answering the phone	Introducing yourself
<u>For calls to your direct line</u> • Good morning, this is Hannah. • Good morning, Polygon firm. Hannah speaking. How can I help you? • Farmani's office, Hannah speaking. <u>For calls to a general number</u> • Thank you for calling Polygon. How may I direct your call?	<u>When calling a general number</u> • May I speak with Janet Ellison? • Hello, this is Brianne Smith calling for Janet Ellison. • Is Janet Ellison in?





Learning Points

Connecting someone	When you don't understand the caller
<u>When you answer the phone and it is for someone else</u> • <i>One minute, I'll transfer you.</i> • <i>Please hold and I'll put you through.</i> • <i>One moment, please.</i> • <i>Just a moment. Can I put you on hold?</i>	• <i>Could you please repeat that?</i> • <i>I'm sorry, I didn't catch that.</i> • <i>I didn't catch what you just said.</i> • <i>Can you speak a little more slowly?</i>

Taking a message for someone	Leaving a message for someone
• <i>I'm sorry, Mark's not here at the moment. Can I take a message?</i> • <i>He's in a meeting at the moment. May I ask who's calling?</i> • <i>He's busy at the moment. Would you like to leave a message?</i>	• <i>Please tell him that Janet called and ask him to call me back. My number is 555-325-5115.</i> • <i>Could you tell him that Janet called?</i> • <i>Please ask him to call Janet when he gets in.</i>

